

Arthroflex**Description**

Reddish orange opaque with white opaque capsule, size 1.

Composition

Each capsule contains Glucosamine Potassium Sulfate equivalent to 250 mg of Glucosamine Sulfate.

Actions and Pharmacology

Glucosamine possesses antiarthrosic-arthrotrophic activities. It stimulates the anabolic metabolism of osteo- cartilaginous tissues via stimulation of the biosynthesis of the mucopolysaccharides (which are the essential components of the cartilage ground-substances) and of the bone mesenchymal tissues. Glucosamine also acts to improve the viscosity of synovial fluid by increasing synovial fluid production, thereby providing lubricant activity.

Pharmacokinetics**Absorption**

Glucosamine sulfate is well absorbed (with a proportion close to 90%) following oral administration.

Protein Binding

It is known that glucosamine and its metabolites bind to α - and β -globulins.

Distribution

Mainly distributed to bone tissues and articular cartilages.

Excretion

Mainly excreted in urine. Small amounts are also excreted in faeces.

Indications

Adjunctive therapy in osteoarthritis

Contraindications and Incompatibilities

Contraindicated in patients sensitive to glucosamine sulfate and shellfish.

Precautions/Warnings

- Arthroflex is not meant to replace NSAIDs in cases of intense pain, as this is a causal therapy. It is advisable to take an anti-inflammatory drug in the initial treatment of osteoarthritis together with glucosamine sulfate.
- Derived from seafood.
- The effect of glucosamine on insulin sensitivity and glucose tolerance is unclear, caution is advised for diabetic patients.

Paediatrics

Not recommended.

Geriatrics

To be taken under medical supervision.

Drug interactions

None known

Incompatibilities

None known

Use in Pregnancy

To be taken under medical supervision.

Main Side/Adverse Effects**Cardiovascular:**

Peripheral oedema, tachycardia were reported in a few patients following larger clinical trials investigating oral administration in osteoarthritis. Causal relationship has not been established.

Central nervous system:

Drowsiness, headache, insomnia have been observed rarely during therapy (less than 1%).

Gastrointestinal:

Nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, dyspepsia or epigastric pain, constipation, heartburn and anorexia have been described rarely during oral therapy with glucosamine.

Skin:

Skin reactions such as erythema and pruritus have been reported with therapeutic administration of glucosamine.

Overdosage

None known

Dosage and Administration**Adults:**

For light to moderate osteoarthritis symptoms: Oral; 2 capsules 2 times daily for 6 weeks, taken 15-30 minutes before meal

For severe osteoarthritis symptoms: Oral; 2 capsules 3 times daily for 8 weeks, taken 15-30 minutes before meal

Maintenance therapy should be followed for 3-4 months by administration of 2 capsules twice daily.

Note: The information given here is limited. For further information consult your doctor or pharmacist.

Storage : Store below 30°C. Protect from moisture.

Presentation/Packing : 100 capsules per amber glass bottle

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